

Razr sharp

Motorola rolling out performance updates for Razr. Will improve camera performance

Kindle full screen update

Amazon Kindle Fire gets full screen web browsing capabilities

display size! The display on the SII is a delight to use as well, the Super AMOLED plus. Extremely vivid colours and very bright as well, with the only real niggle (if we nitpick) is that the reds can be a little overbearing. We don't really see this on smartphones, but you have the settings for cool, normal and vivid for color. Wasn't that the domain of flat panel televisions? Battery life is surprisingly good as well. Surprising we say because of the sheer power the SII packs. However, what can certainly be held against the SII is the extremely plasticky build. The idea was to keep the weight down, but for a phone that costs above ₹30,000, this just doesn't seem right. However, the SII offers tremendous value. It is the lowest priced among all phones above ₹30,000 and has a performance only second to the Galaxy Note.

LG Optimus 3D was the first high-end 3D phone to arrive on our shores, and the package is extremely impressive. Admittedly, it isn't very slim, and is definitely on the heavier side. However, packed in are dual cameras for 3D pictures and videos, and a 3D display. To allow users to enjoy the 3D experience straight out of the box, LG have preloaded

a bunch of 3D games, images and videos on the phone. The 3D display was working very well, and the depth that was offered on a 4.3-inch display impressed us. Since this is the "glass-less" version of 3D, there is a convenience bit to it. It is a disappointment of enormous proportions that the Optimus 3D still hasn't been updated beyond Android 2.2, which will definitely put off a few buyers. We believe 3D is a feature that will not yet entice a lot of buyers.

Carrying on with the 3D theme, the other phone is the HTC Evo 3D. It feels better to hold than the Optimus 3D, and the slightly lighter color theme gels well with the tinge of red. There is a dedicated key to switch between 2D and 3D modes. The display isn't as bright as the one



Samsung Galaxy Note

looking BlackBerry device we have seen in a long time. What RIM has done here is made a phone that manages bling and



Sony Ericsson Xperia Arc S

on the Optimus 3D, but handles colours equally well. 3D performance, however, is miles apart. If you remember, we had praised the 3D depth of the LG phone, but the same can't be said for the Evo 3D. The depth definitely wasn't there, and the real annoying thing was there was no preloaded 3D content. At least a few images and videos were critical, since it helps with the 'enjoy out of the box' routine. If a 3D phone is really what you want, we suggest buying the Optimus 3D, since it is better at the unique feature that both phones tout.

There really is no other way of saying this – the Bold Touch 9900 is a very impressive phone. We can confidently say that this is by far the best-

understated elegance, all at once. The 2.8-inch display is a capable touchscreen, and OS 7 performs delightfully on the 1GHz processor. And we haven't come to the best part yet. The QWERTY keypad is by far the best ever on a BlackBerry device, and miles ahead of any QWERTY we have seen in a very long time. Add a good battery life into the mix, and this is the phone to buy. If you want a high-end business device, or a very capable expensive phone to show off to the buddies, this is the Bold you should consider.

HTC Sensation XE is what Sensation should have been in the first place. While the design and dimensions remain like the Sensation, the Beats Audio Special Edition genes are clearly visible, thanks to the red LEDs and the tinge of red at multiple places on the phone. But the real difference is in the power package. While the Sensation had the 1.2GHz version of the Cortex A9 processor, the XE gets a 1.5GHz processor. The resultant performance boost is tremendous. The XE has significantly better benchmark scores, and the UI feels much slicker to use as well. The bigger battery on the XE means it does better than its cousin on that front as well. As we had explained earlier, the Sensation had serious network issues – signal drops and the Wi-Fi grip of death. If you remove the battery cover on the Sensation, all network signals drop out. In the XE, remove the battery cover and the only change is that the network switches from 3G to EDGE networks, but continues working as a phone. The display is the same as the Sensation, but the way HTC Sense responds is very different – way more fluid and responsive on the XE. If you were considering buying the Sensation, we suggest you think about spending a little more and getting the XE instead.

The Razr is back and it hasn't put on any weight. It looks absolutely brilliant, and the build quality is quite classy. How-



HTC Evo 3D



LG Optimus 3D